

## HOW TO MAKE

This effervescent beverage can be easily prepared at home, and is a good alternative to fizzy drinks, as it is lighter and contains acids and enzymes that aid digestion. All you need is a clean work area, some simple equipment, ingredients, and the willingness to wait for the tea to ferment.

**1** Place the spring water in a large 4-quart saucepan and bring to a boil. Then remove from the heat, add the tea leaves, and steep for 5 minutes.

**2** Strain the tea into the large glass jar and discard the tea leaves. Add the sugar and stir until it has dissolved. Cover the container loosely and leave to cool for several hours.

**3** When the tea has cooled, add the store-bought Kombucha, stirring with a wooden spoon. Wearing the gloves, place the SCOBY inside the jar. Cover the jar with the cloth, fastening it with an elastic band to keep out flies and molds.

**4** Leave the glass jar with the SCOBY and tea to sit undisturbed and away from sunlight for a week. The SCOBY will sink to the bottom as it ferments. After several days it will either rise to the top, or another SCOBY will start its culture at the top and grow thicker.



### YOU WILL NEED

#### Ingredients

- 1 gallon spring water
- 8 tsp black loose-leaf tea
- 1 cup cane sugar
- 2 cups unpasteurized, unflavored store-bought Kombucha (to use as "starter" liquid)

Kombucha SCOBY

#### Special equipment

- 1 gallon sterile glass jar, plus 1-quart sterile glass jar
- pair of new vinyl or latex gloves
- piece of clean fineweave cloth, large enough to cover the top of the jar
- elastic band
- 6 x 16fl oz (500ml) sterile bottles
- 1 plastic funnel

**5** After fermentation, try a little sample with a wooden spoon to check the sparkle and flavor. It should have a light sparkle, like champagne, and taste like apple cider vinegar. If it is too sweet, leave it to ferment a little longer. The timing will need some experimentation, give or take a few days.

**6** When the Kombucha is ready, remove the SCOBY and place it in the smaller glass jar. Pour in 3 cups of the prepared Kombucha and close the lid. Refrigerate for up to 2 months until you are ready to start the next batch.

**7** Pour the remaining Kombucha into the bottles through the plastic funnel. Close the lids and let them sit for a "secondary fermentation" for several days to add extra effervescence. Once fermented, store the bottles in the fridge. If you want to flavor it, just before bottling, add 1 part fresh or preserved fruit juice to 5 parts Kombucha.